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TAB 22



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-040-24/25, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 2/11/2025**In Control:** Board of Education

Mr. Melvoin - It Takes a Village: Expanding LA Unified's Housing Efforts (Res-040-24/25) (Noticed January 14, 2025))

Whereas, Los Angeles is experiencing a housing crisis, and skyrocketing rents and home prices are leading to higher costs of living and increasing levels of homelessness. The Affordable Housing Outcomes Report presented to the Los Angeles County Board of Supervisors in September 2023, found that the County lacks over 500,000 affordable homes to meet the current demand among renter households at or below 50 percent of the area median income;

Whereas, Los Angeles Unified School District (District) employees commute long distances to serve our students while seeking reasonably priced rentals and homes outside District boundaries;

Whereas, The District operates 1,200 schools and centers and owns 21,000 buildings-more than 78 million square feet-and 6,400 acres or 10 square miles of land;

Whereas, The District has underutilized assets including closed schools or other facilities, former agricultural land, and portions of school sites with excess storage;

Whereas, Joint occupancy and other legal vehicles allow the District to enter into public-private partnerships to leverage underutilized assets for the purpose of providing value to the District;

Whereas, Starting in 2015, the District has utilized specific District-owned properties to provide 185 units of affordable family housing-with preference given to District staff and employees-at Sage Park in Gardena, Selma Community Housing in Hollywood, and Norwood Learning Village in Los Angeles;

Whereas, Currently, over 7,000 District employees are on the waitlist for housing at the three existing projects;

Whereas, Providing employee housing will help make the District an employer of choice by helping attract and retain qualified teachers and staff, reducing commute times to and from work which has a positive impact on the environment, and alleviating the regional housing shortage;

Whereas, In September 2016, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District unanimously passed "Exploring Options to Develop Workforce Housing in Sun Valley for Employees of the Los Angeles Unified School District" which directed the Superintendent to study the development of additional workforce housing;

Whereas, In March 2017, the Facilities and Audit Committee received a presentation entitled, "Using Underutilized Assets to Address District Goals and Priorities;"

Whereas, In November 2018, the Board passed "Increasing Opportunities and Supports for Our Homeless Students and Families" in order to support students and families experiencing homelessness;

Whereas, In June 2020, The Superintendent presented a Real Estate Evaluation detailing the 21,000 District owned buildings across 6,400 acres of land. The goal was to develop 2,000 units of housing for LA Unified employees, including teachers;

Whereas, In November 2020, the Superintendent recommended that the Board approve the issuance of Request for Proposals (RFPs) seeking proposals for the sale, lease, exchange, or other disposal of three District properties and consider proposals for employee housing at 10 vacant District properties;

Whereas, In June 2021, the District launched a new effort to provide affordable housing which would allow District teachers, staff and families to live in the communities they serve. The Board authorized \$1.5 million from the General Fund to conduct due diligence activities for the purpose of identifying options to provide affordable employee housing;

Whereas, In Fall 2023, the District released a Request for Expression of Interest (REI) for the development and financing of housing for District employees and families. It garnered responses from development firms and financial institutions willing to support the District's housing initiative. The below preliminary sites identified in the REI included nine District owned sites that were vacant and/or underutilized and not part of a school:

- Paved parking lot located at 4523 Exposition Blvd. Los Angeles, CA 90016;
- Vacant parcel adjacent to Vista Hermosa Park;
- Vacant lot located at the intersection of Shoup Ave. and Collins St.;
- Multiple portable buildings and parking lot located at 1049 N. Fairfax Ave. West Hollywood, CA 90046;
- Vacant paved lot located at 2726 Francis Ave. Los Angeles, CA 90005;
- Vacant paved lot located at 644 E 56th St. Los Angeles, CA 90011;
- Vacant paved lot located at 234 E 112th St. Los Angeles, CA 90061;
- Vacant 3-story medical building, surface parking, and storage building located at 10339 Balboa Blvd. Granada Hills, CA 91344; and
- Vacant unimproved lot located at 4315 New York Ave. Los Angeles, CA 90022

Whereas, In November 2023, a Community Briefing was held to discuss the District's initiative regarding affordable housing and preview the survey to assess housing needs;

Whereas, In May 2024, the District surveyed employees and families to gauge interest in a range of housing options. Data from the survey is meant to support the District's efforts to potentially repurpose underutilized real estate assets to provide housing that is more affordable for employees and families;

Whereas, In October 2024, the Facilities and Procurement committee heard an update on the District's Housing Initiative; and

Whereas, Despite the extensive timeline and current demand for housing, the District has not yet released RFPs for workforce housing for over a decade and can't say with certainty when they will be released; now, therefore be it

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Resolved, At the Committee of the Whole meeting on January 28, 2025, the Los Angeles Unified School District shall present to the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District and the public the following:

- Data collected from the Housing Survey and appropriate analysis;
- Plan to solicit proposals by June 1, 2025, for the nine vacant and/or underutilized sites identified in the REI to create additional affordable workforce housing units;
- Timeline of key dates and activities from now through the proposed completion of the aforementioned units; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the District shall provide quarterly reports to the Board outlining progress towards the development of employee housing units until they are completed.